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INDUSTRIAL AND MANUFACTURING ACCOUNTS

Sixteen years of enterprise selling, most of it into organizations that make, move or refine something.

Manufacturing and consumer products: Anheuser-Busch, Post Holdings, US Foods, Panera Bread and Emerson across the Couchbase, Red Hat and Adobe books.

Energy, refining and heavy industry: SLB in Houston closed this year, plus Exxon, Xcel Energy, Ameren, FirstEnergy and OG&E.

Distribution, supply chain and transportation: Graybar, Union Pacific, Walmart, Dell, Sears and Enterprise Holdings.

Why it carries over: These buyers measure uptime, throughput and yield. The conversation starts with an operational number and ends with a financial one, and I have run that sequence for most of my career.

ATTAINMENT RECORD

Red Hat, \$7M. 160%. Then 128% of \$5M and 137% of \$3.5M. Three consecutive years over plan. President's Club.

Alfresco, \$4M regional target. 146%. Full P&L, three enterprise AEs, my own \$1.5M inside the team number. President's Club.

Couchbase, territory number. 135%. Every dollar from a new customer, carried through the July 2021 IPO.

Gigamon, \$750K region. 125%. Directed the SDR, sales engineer and professional services against one number.

Cloudflare, \$1M. 115%. More than \$4M of pipeline across 35 named prospects, nearly all self-sourced.

Adobe, \$2M annual. Cleared all four years. Over \$5M of enterprise revenue in the period. Two-time President's Club.

MAPPING TO THE ROLE

Pipeline generation. Every seat I have held started empty. Cloudflare reached more than \$4M in self-sourced pipeline across 35 named prospects. Couchbase went from nothing to roughly \$4M, a 45% increase, closing at 135% on new logos alone.

Full cycle through contract execution. Prospecting, discovery, evaluation, negotiation and signature have all been mine. Centene ran from a cold account to a \$5M annual agreement with no handoff at any stage.

Multiple stakeholder groups. I open large accounts by working several threads in parallel and learning what each group is measured on before proposing anything. Operations, IT, architecture, security and finance rarely agree on priorities at the start.

ROI and value selling. My career started in corporate procurement, so I build the financial case in the format the committee will actually evaluate, then defend it through vendor review and legal.

System integrators and channel. WWT signed personally at Red Hat and carried across four employers. Deal registration, joint account planning and co-sell through Optiv, GuidePoint Security, SHI, CDW and AWS.

Pre-sales and services partnership. Technical evaluations and demonstrations run with engineering alongside me, with written success criteria agreed before anything starts. Professional services attached on my largest agreements.

Trade shows and regional presence. A regional user group grown from roughly 20 attendees to 150 with me presenting, plus a technology summit I helped found. Field events are a standing part of how I build pipeline.

Salesforce discipline. Weekly opportunity-level inspection with a current next step, a named risk and the executive ask on every deal, rolled into a forecast that holds.

ANCHOR DEAL: \$5M ANNUAL AGREEMENT, RED HAT

- Opened cold into a Fortune 25 organization with no active project and no budget line for the category.
- Worked infrastructure, application development, security and enterprise architecture as separate threads before proposing anything.
- Ran the technical evaluation directly, then built the modernization and total cost case with the CFO organization.
- Cleared architecture review, vendor risk assessment, procurement and legal over several months, redlines included, and displaced an embedded incumbent.
- Signed at \$5M annually with professional services attached, anchoring a year that closed at 160% of \$7M.

LEARNING A CATEGORY QUICKLY

Four times I have picked up a product the buyer had no budget line for and finished over plan.

- Red Hat, open source in the enterprise. Procurement had no template for it and security had objections nobody had answered.
- Couchbase, NoSQL before it had a settled place in the stack. Closed 135% on new customers alone.
- Cloudflare, Zero Trust while the term still meant different things to different vendors. Closed 115% of \$1M.
- Analyst1, AI-driven intelligence today, sold into buyers who press hard on data handling before signing.
- The pattern each time: learn the product well enough to run discovery unsupported, find the two or three accounts where the problem is already urgent, and let those become the reference that makes the next ten easier.